

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4**PART A Group Interaction**

Below is some information regarding a survey about Generation Y in the workplace:

Recruiting firm specializes in Gen Y candidates

A recruiting firm called Jobfind specializes in recruiting Generation Y job seekers. Its mission is to find jobs for thousands of capable young people (young professionals aged 30 or under) who are very talented but often get overlooked by employers who only focus on grades and the number of extra-curricular activities that applicants have done.

A survey was conducted to investigate how employers in Hong Kong felt about their Gen Y employees. Here are some major findings:

Question 1. 59% of the employers said that they found it difficult to manage Gen Y staff because of the following:

- Lack of loyalty
- Unrealistic job expectations
- Impatience
- Need of constant attention
- Little respect for authority

Question 2. The employers took the following measures to make their workplace more attractive to their Gen Y employees:

- Setting up mentorship or coaching programmes
- Encouraging own initiative and independent thinking
- Allowing flexible working hours and more work-life balance
- Adopting a more casual environment (e.g. wearing jeans and t-shirt or working from home)

The survey also found that members of Gen Y are tech-savvy and know how to use social media to gain opportunities. These younger workers are also regarded as being the most “enthusiastic” about their jobs. On the down side, they are rarely considered as team players or hardworking at work.

As members of the Careers Team, your group is designing a workshop for Gen Y school leavers. Discuss with your group what to include in the workshop. You may want to talk about:

- whether you agree with the description of Gen Y in Question 1
- which measures taken by employers in Question 2 would be most popular with young employees
- how to make the workshop interesting
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Would you like to work for someone or for yourself?
2. Do you think wearing jeans to work is appropriate?
3. Do you think you would be a good employee?
4. What are the qualities of a good boss?
5. Do you think it is important to always follow the instructions of your boss?
6. If you did not agree with your boss' decision, what would you do?
7. Do you share any of the characteristics of Gen Y?
8. Which is more important: job loyalty or better job prospects?